

VANESSA SERRANO

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UX/Product Designer and Software Engineer with experience in user research, wire framing, prototyping, and usability testing. Skilled in Figma, design systems, accessibility (WCAG), and responsive front-end frameworks. Combines technical development expertise with UX design to create accessible, data-driven, user-centered products.

EDUCATION

University of Florida

December 2025

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Minor in Digital Arts and Sciences

Gainesville, Florida

- **AI Fundamentals Certification**
- **Relevant Coursework:** Human Computer Interaction, UX Design, Operating Systems, Data structures and Algorithm, Algorithm Abstraction and Design, Introduction to Computer Organization, AI Fundamentals, Digital Visualization & Culture
- **Clubs:** Gator User Design, WICSE, SEC, Girls Who Code

EXPERIENCE

UX Designer / Web Developer Intern

August 2025 - Present

Cinema Verde

Gainesville, Florida

- Modernized website using **Squarespace**, implementing responsive, mobile-first layouts to improve usability.
- Enhanced accessibility compliance and navigation for a **40%** faster user experience.
- Published multimedia content to a **Roku** channel, optimizing performance for streaming users.

Software Engineer Intern

May 2025 - July 2025

Publix Super Markets

Lakeland, Florida

- Designed and developed a **GS1 DataMatrix barcode validation tool** using **C#, SQL, and XAML**
- Improved validation speed by **98%**, reducing processing time from **15 minutes to 15 seconds**.
- Integrated **REST APIs** and deployed the solution within **Agile/Azure DevOps** workflows.

Resident Assistant

August 2022 - May 2024

University of Florida

Gainesville, Florida

- Fostered an inclusive community for **100+ residents** from diverse backgrounds.
- Organized events, managed budgets, and designed promotional materials.
- Resolved concerns through **mediation and crisis management** while on-call.

PROJECTS

ARC: Action, Resources, Care

2025

- Designed and prototyped a confidential mobile app for first responders, from research with **41 interviews**.
- Created user flows and **high-fidelity Figma** designs focused on accessibility, empathy, and ease of use.
- Built working **React Native** prototype with Flask + MongoDB backend, and AI-powered check-ins.

The RecipeGrind

2024

- Built recipe recommendation app with **React, Express, and PostgreSQL** for efficient ingredient-based search.
- Implemented a **Pantry Mode algorithm** and **Material UI** interface for real-time filtering and recipe scoring.
- Enhanced API reliability using proxy caching and integrated the **Spoonacular API** for recipe data.

UF Events

2024

- Conducted **user interviews** with University of Florida students to identify engagement challenges.
- Designed **low- and high-fidelity wireframes** in **Figma**, improving accessibility and event discovery UX.
- Prototyped an event-discovery platform promoting campus participation and community inclusion.

SKILLS

- **Design Tools:** Figma, Git/GitHub, Azure DevOps, Webflow, Agile/Scrum, Miro, Notion
- **Languages:** JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Java, C++, C#, SQL, XAML
- **Front-End:** React, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, Material-UI, Xamarin.Forms, Accessibility (WCAG)
- **Back-End:** Django, Prisma, PostgreSQL, .NET, Express